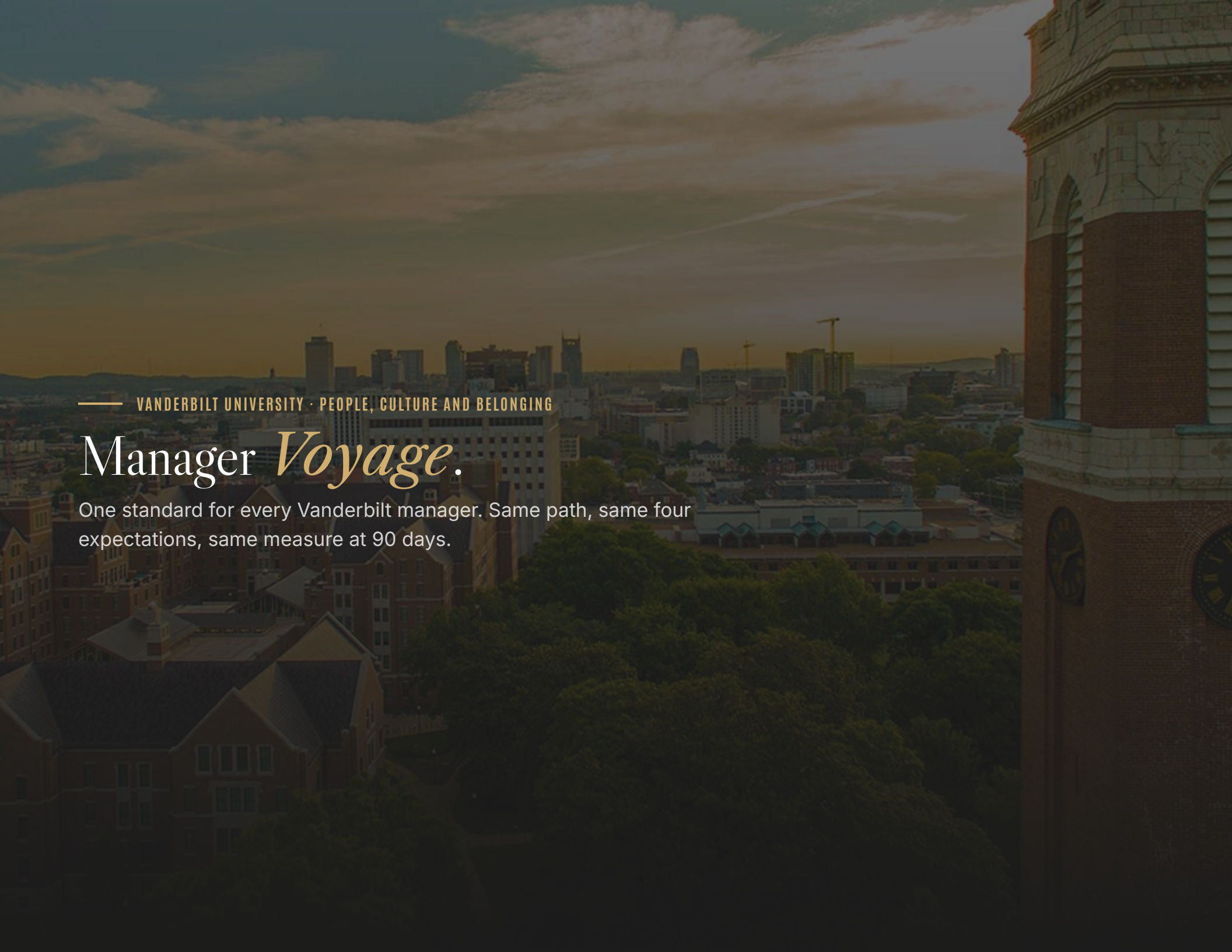


VANDERBILT UNIVERSITY · PEOPLE, CULTURE AND BELONGING

# Manager *Voyage*.

One standard for every Vanderbilt manager. Same path, same four expectations, same measure at 90 days.

01 THE VANDERBILT MANAGER STANDARD

# Every manager is held to the same four *expectations*.

One standard, every business unit. Taught, measured, practiced.

**01**

### Get the work done

through the team, not around it

**02**

### Take care of your people

listen, grow, thank, trust

**03**

### Make things better

explain the why, let people try, look back

**04**

### Connect your team

to the rest of Vanderbilt

Adapted from Gary Yukl's four categories of leadership behavior. Ten assessment statements, before the program and at 90 days.

## WHERE THE STANDARD COMES FROM, AND HOW THE ASSESSMENT MEASURES IT

The standard is adapted from Gary Yukl's taxonomy of leadership behavior (*Academy of Management Perspectives*, 2012). The four expectations are his four categories, the fifteen behaviors are his fifteen, and each of the ten assessment statements is one behavior written as something a manager does in a normal week. Five behaviors have no statement of their own (problem solving, developing, envisioning change, encouraging innovation, networking), so the ten statements sample the standard and the course teaches all fifteen. A self-reflection tool adapted for Vanderbilt, not a validated Yukl instrument, and not a performance evaluation.

# The standard, *continued*.

## WHERE THE STANDARD COMES FROM, AND HOW THE ASSESSMENT MEASURES IT

| EXPECTATION | YUKL'S CATEGORY | THE FIFTEEN BEHAVIORS | ASSESSMENT STATEMENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| **01 Get the work done** | Task-oriented | Planning, clarifying, monitoring, problem solving | 1 Priorities, 2 Expectations, 3 Checking work |
| **02 Take care of your people** | Relations-oriented | Supporting, developing, recognizing, empowering | 4 Supporting, 5 Recognizing, 6 Empowering |
| **03 Make things better** | Change-oriented | Advocating change, envisioning change, encouraging innovation, facilitating collective learning | 7 Leading change, 8 Looking back |
| **04 Connect your team** | External | Networking, external monitoring, representing | 9 Watching ahead, 10 Representing |

02 PROGRAM OVERVIEW

# One standard for the first 60 days, and *beyond*.

Assigned automatically from the HR record. Four parts.

**4,600+**
Staff led by Vanderbilt managers

**500+**
Vanderbilt managers

**39**
Business units using the same standard

**60**
Days covered by the initial path

01 · REQUIRED

## Compliance

DAYS 1 TO 60

Legal and policy, by state.

02 · STRONGLY RECOMMENDED

## Foundations

COURSE BY DAY 7

Assessment, 35-minute course, micro modules.

03 · OPTIONAL BUT RECOMMENDED

## Four-week cohort

QUARTERLY

Practice with your own team.

04 · ALWAYS AVAILABLE

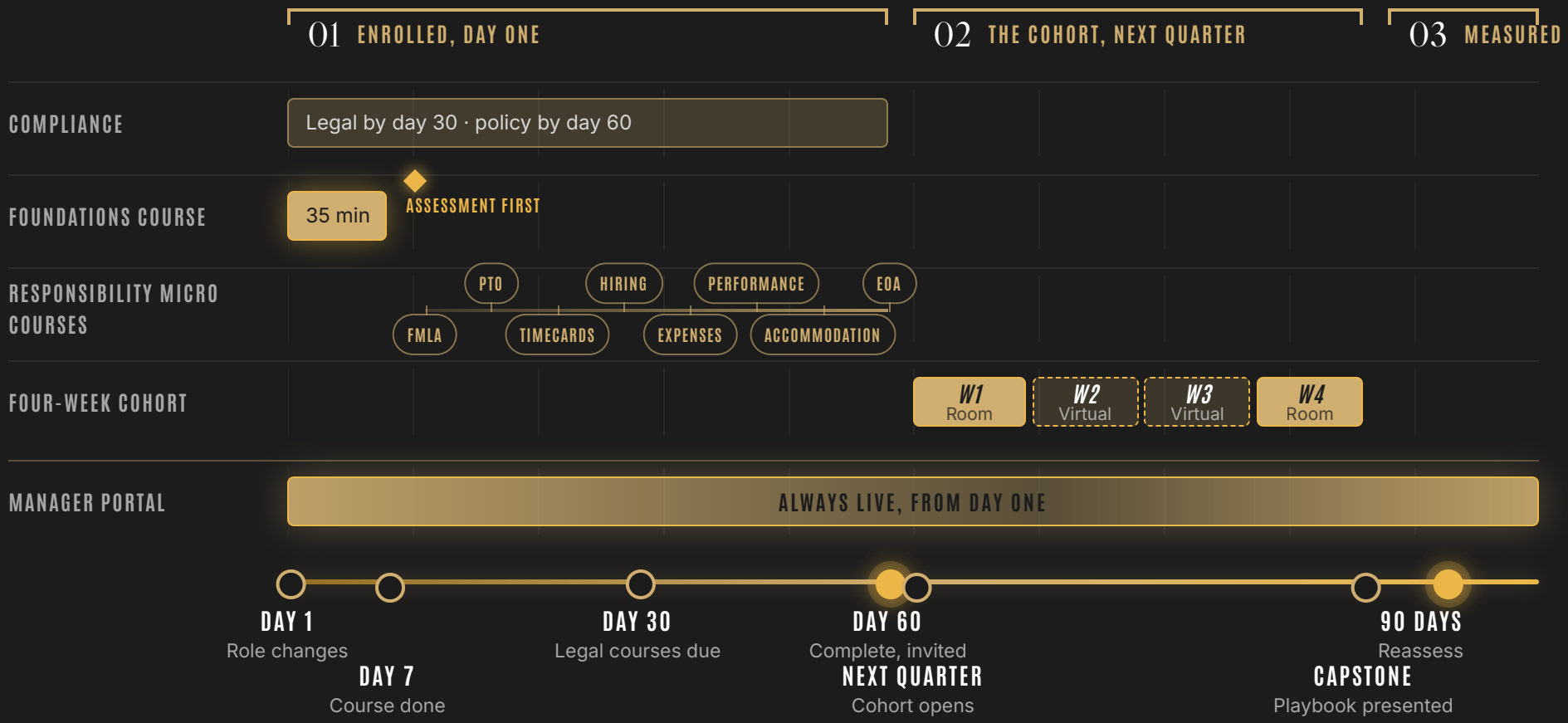
## Manager Portal

ALWAYS LIVE

Templates, policy, who to call.

THE JOURNEY

# Day one to *ninety*, on one line.



THE JOURNEY

# The manager's journey, *continued*.

## EACH STAGE, IN A SENTENCE

### Day 1, enrolled

- **Enrolled on the first day.** Oracle Learning assigns compliance and Manager Foundations from the HR record. Nothing to request.
- **Compliance.** The legal and policy courses for the state the team works in, supervisor versions included. Legal by day 30, policy by day 60.
- **The Foundations course.** *You Are a Manager Now*, thirty-five minutes online by day seven: the assessment first, then six topics with live conversations, scored.

### Days 7 to 60, responsibilities

- **Micro courses, one task each.** FMLA and leave, PTO and timecards, hiring, expenses, the performance cycle, accommodations, reporting to EOA. Short, in Oracle Learning, taken as the responsibility arrives.
- **Day 60.** Recorded against the job profile. The cohort invitation goes out.

### Next quarter, the cohort

- **Enroll.** The enrollment survey: a seat request and the team profile, four taps that tailor every scenario.
- **Four weeks.** Week 1 in the classroom, three hours. Weeks 2 and 3 virtual, under ninety minutes. Week 4 the capstone, two hours, the Playbook presented.
- **A survey after every session, then completion.**

### Measured, and always live

- **Reassess.** The same ten statements at 90 days, and the team's view from three or more direct reports.
- **The Manager Portal.** Every template, policy link and contact, open from the first day and never taken away.

COMPONENT 01 · REQUIRED · DAYS 1 TO 60

# Assigned on day one, matched to the *state*.

No enrollment step. Oracle Learning holds the record.

**30**
days for courses required by law

**60**
days for policy courses

**1 yr**
then most renew

### Every location

Cybersecurity · HIPAA · Harassment · Clery · Accommodations

### Tennessee

### New York

### California

### Florida

# Component 01 · Compliance, *continued*.

## EVERY COURSE, BY LOCATION

### Every location

- Foundational Cybersecurity Training 30 MIN
- VU HIPAA Privacy and Security Training 60 MIN · LEGAL
- Addressing Harassment and Discrimination at Vanderbilt 35 MIN · LEGAL
- Clery Act 20 MIN · LEGAL
- Guidelines for Reasonable Accommodations in the Workplace 45 MIN · MANAGERS

### Tennessee

- Eliminating Discrimination and Harassment in the Workplace 45 MIN
- Harassment Prevention: Manager Essentials 45 MIN · MANAGERS

### New York

- Harassment Prevention for Employees, New York City and State 45 MIN · LEGAL
- Harassment Prevention for Supervisors 60 MIN · LEGAL
- New York Retail Worker Safety Act, staff and supervisors 30 MIN · RETAIL ONLY

### California

- Sexual Harassment Prevention, employees (SB 1343) 60 MIN · LEGAL
- Sexual Harassment Prevention, supervisors 120 MIN · LEGAL
- Workplace Violence Prevention, employees and supervisors (SB 553) 30 TO 45 MIN · LEGAL

### Florida

- Human Trafficking Awareness, lodging staff and supervisors 30 MIN · LEGAL
- Harassment Prevention, employees and supervisors 45 MIN

Delivered through OpenSesame inside Oracle Learning. Each course ends with a knowledge check.

COMPONENT 02 · STRONGLY RECOMMENDED · DAYS 1 TO 60

# What Vanderbilt expects, in *three parts*.

In order. Assigned to every current manager too.

**01**

### The assessment

BEFORE THE COURSE · AGAIN AT 90 DAYS

Ten statements, scored by expectation.

**02**

### The Foundation course

35 MINUTES · COMPLETE BY DAY 7

*You Are a Manager Now.* Six topics, live conversations.

**03**

### The micro modules

DAYS 1 TO 60 · ORACLE LEARNING

One task each, four tracks.

Done by Day 60: recorded against the job profile, cohort invitation sent.

## THE SIX TOPICS AND THE FOUR TRACKS

### The Foundation course, six topics

- **What a manager is.** The one change, three things that are new, who helps you.
- **Five ideas.** Priorities, clear expectations, psychological safety, purpose, the people work. A live conversation for each.
- **Your first year.** What Vanderbilt asks for and when, and a three-tap week the manager adds to their calendar.
- **The Vanderbilt Manager Standard.** The four expectations, Yukl's category for each, the fifteen behaviors on flip cards, a story per expectation, and the map from expectation to assessment statement, then four live conversations.
- **Your assessment.** The result by expectation, which statements sit under each, and the first move.
- **Next steps.** One action this week, a note to their manager, course complete.

### The micro modules, four tracks

- **Systems, by Day 30.** UKG for managers; Oracle time off; Oracle HCM team view and approvals; Oracle Recruiting and Onboarding; expense and procurement approvals.
- **Vanderbilt & Nashville, by Day 30.** The mission and vision; areas of focus; our campuses; Nashville; how we work together.
- **People, by Day 60.** Employee Relations grounding; EOA reporting duty; FMLA; reasonable accommodations; performance concerns simulator; onboarding a new hire.
- **Processes, by Day 60.** Performance Management Foundations; giving feedback; compensation and merit basics; flexible work; offboarding and transitions.

COMPONENT 03 · OPTIONAL BUT RECOMMENDED · QUARTERLY

# Where the standard becomes *practice*.

One hundred managers a quarter, with their own teams, in their own words.

WEEK 1 · IN THE CLASSROOM · 3 HOURS

### What it means to manage

The mission, your line, the hard conversation out loud.

WEEK 2 · VIRTUAL · UNDER 90 MIN

### Goals, 1:1s, difficult conversations

The 1:1 that turns difficult.

WEEK 3 · VIRTUAL · UNDER 90 MIN

### Coaching and mentoring

Coach, then hand it over.

WEEK 4 · IN THE CLASSROOM · 2 HOURS

### The capstone

The performance conversation, the Playbook presented.

One Playbook, started in the room, one section a week, presented whole in week four.

## LOGISTICS AND WHAT EVERY PARTICIPANT PRODUCES

### Logistics

- **Week one.** A half day in the classroom, facilitated by the Futures Learning Hub from the cohort site, with timers, talk notes, and a QR code on every page.
- **Weeks two and three.** Virtual, on the manager's own time, capped at ninety minutes.
- **Week four.** Two hours in the classroom. Managers present to peers and their business unit leader.
- **Seats.** One hundred a quarter. Units outside the central budget are billed per seat.

### Deliverables

- **Manager Playbook.** The written personal operating system: philosophy, 1:1 framework, delegation and growth plan, performance practice.
- **Integrated Management Model.** A one-page model of how the four expectations connect for this manager. Synthesis, not attendance.
- **Team Development Plan.** A 90-day plan for the actual team: names, goals, growth moves. Challenged by peers and presented in week four.

COMPONENT 03 · WEEK BY WEEK

# One expectation a week, one habit *kept*.

**BEFORE**

## Set your team

Four taps. Every scenario rewrites itself.

**WEEK 1 · 03 MAKE THINGS BETTER**

## What it means to manage

Classroom · 3 hours

**WEEK 2 · 01 GET THE WORK DONE**

## Goals, 1:1s, and difficult conversations

Virtual · under 90 minutes

**WEEK 3 · 02 TAKE CARE OF YOUR PEOPLE**

## Coaching and mentoring

Virtual · under 90 minutes

**WEEK 4 · 04 CONNECT YOUR TEAM**

## Performance, talent, and your Playbook

Classroom · 2 hours · the capstone

## EACH WEEK IN DETAIL

### Week 1 · In the classroom · 3 hours

| | |
|---|---|
| ROOM | The mission, fifteen minutes: what your team makes possible, in one sentence. The pulse, first reading. |
| ACTIVITIES | Your voyage on a timeline, from the work you were hired for to year one. A week of your own work sorted into the four expectations. Which expectation your team needs most, and the habit that serves it. |
| LAB | The hard conversation, fifty minutes: the three-line frame, a demonstration, pairs, then live with Sam on your phone. |
| PLAYBOOK | Section 1: Manager Philosophy, written and read aloud to your four. |

### Week 2 · Virtual · under 90 minutes

| | |
|---|---|
| CORE | How to Manage Difficult Conversations, in Oracle Learning, 30 minutes. |
| LAB | SparkWise, 45 minutes: conversation prep with peers. Bring the one you have been putting off; leave with it framed in three lines. |
| SIMULATION | The 1:1 that turns difficult. Dev has missed two dates and opens as if nothing is wrong. Ten minutes, tailored to your team. |
| PLAYBOOK | Section 2: cadence, agenda, three goals per person, your opening sentence. |

COMPONENT 03 · WEEK BY WEEK

# The cohort · Week by week, *continued*.

## EACH WEEK IN DETAIL

### Week 3 · Virtual · under 90 minutes

| | |
|---|---|
| CORE | Coaching Skills for Leaders and Managers, in Oracle Learning, 35 minutes. |
| LAB | SparkWise, 40 minutes: the delegation lab and coach or correct. What you will hand off this month, to whom, with what boundary. |
| SIMULATION | Coach, then hand it over. Priya wants to grow and expects you to tell her how. Ask first; then a real decision with one boundary and a date. |
| PLAYBOOK | Section 3: one line per person, where they want to be, the stretch assignment, the rung. |

### Week 4 · In the classroom · 2 hours

| | |
|---|---|
| RECAP | The four expectations read back against three weeks: what you tried, what held, what did not. |
| PRACTICE | The performance conversation with Marcus, who expects a promotion you cannot give this cycle. Pairs, then live. |
| PRESENT | Five minutes each in fours, business unit leaders in the room: the sentence at the center, the team goal, one person's plan by name, the habit you kept. Peers challenge one goal, one move, one date. |
| CLOSE | The pulse, second reading, beside the week-one answers. The 90-day reassessment date. |

COMPONENT 04 · ALWAYS AVAILABLE

# The Manager *Portal*.

Every template, policy link and contact. Open from day one, never taken away.

| | |
|---|---|
| TEMPLATES | 1:1 agenda, conversation frame, delegation ladder, Playbook. |
| POLICY | Leave, flexible work, accommodations, performance. |
| BEYOND | Vetted podcasts, videos, guides. |

WHO TO CALL

## Same-day routes and everyday *help*.

| | |
|---|---|
| YOUR HCM | The first call, the same day. |
| ENGAGEMENT CONSULTANT | The bigger people questions. |
| LEAVE OFFICE | FMLA, time off, injuries. Never ask for a diagnosis. |
| EOA | Report the same day. You do not investigate. |

HOW IT WAS BUILT, AND HOW IMPACT IS MEASURED

# Built with managers, measured at *90 days*.

THE EXPERT GROUP

### Seven divisions

Set the rules and the Day 30 and 60 bar.

THE PILOT · MARCH 26, 2026

### Fifteen managers, eight units

Completed it all. Shaped the design.

NOW LIVE

### Automatic assignment

Assigned from the HR record.

NOVEMBER 1, 2026

### Wide launch

All managers. First cohort of one hundred.

**80%**

of M1 to M5 managers enrolled

**3 of 4**

expectations improved per manager, at 90 days

**10**

statements, before and after, by expectation

## THE OUTCOMES WE EXPECT, AND HOW WE WILL SEE THEM

### Engaged

- Managers who understand the role, take ownership of it, and stay at Vanderbilt.
- **How we will see it:** enrollment and Day 60 completion in Oracle Learning against the 80 percent target; cohort seats filled each quarter.

### Supporting

- Teams with clear expectations, timely feedback, and the confidence to raise concerns.
- **How we will see it:** assessment gains in getting the work done and taking care of people.

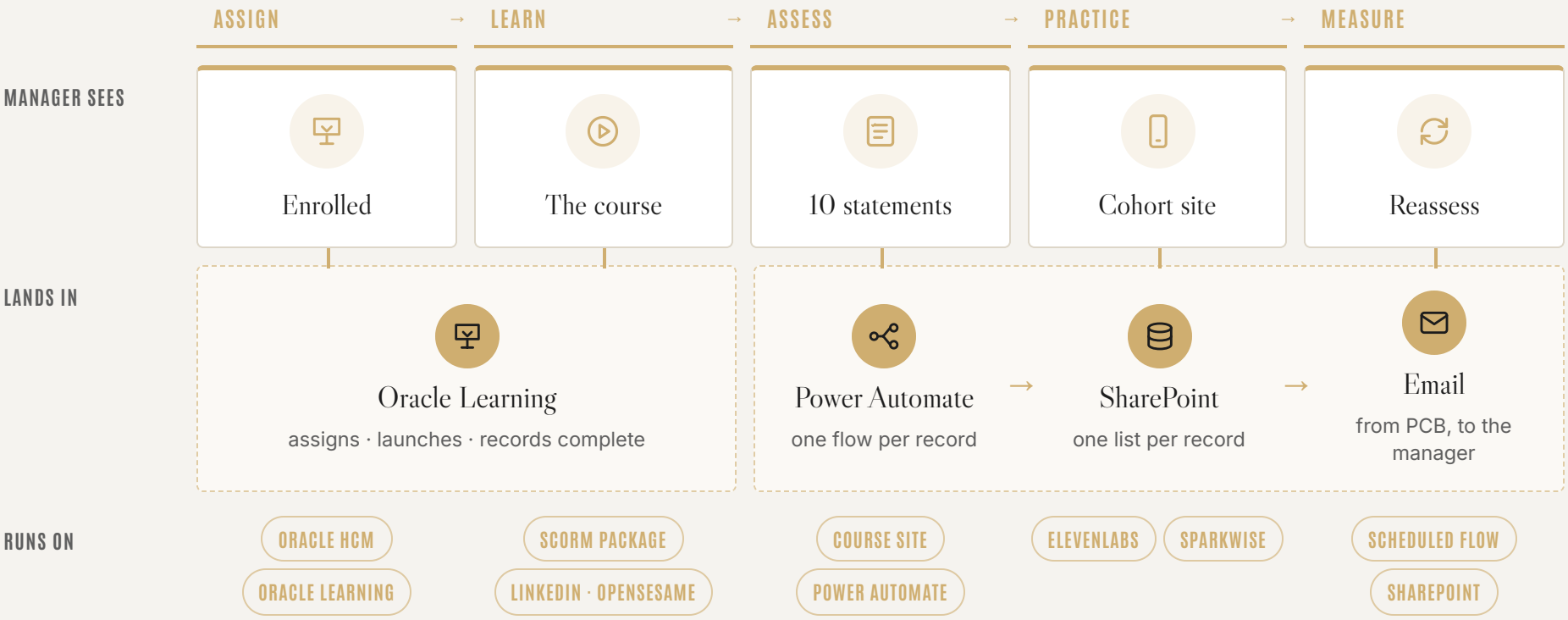
### Championing

- Managers who can explain Vanderbilt's purpose in their own words and connect the team's work to it.
- **How we will see it:** assessment gains in making things better and connecting the team; completion of the Vanderbilt & Nashville track.

The standard and the assessment are adapted from Yukl's taxonomy of leadership behavior (2012): the four expectations are his four categories and the ten statements are ten of his fifteen behaviors. An adaptation for Vanderbilt, not a validated instrument, and not a performance evaluation.

BEHIND THE SCENES

# Front stage, *back stage*.




One static site: GitHub → Vercel, the course zipped as the SCORM package

Three lists: assessments, surveys, completions

Five voices, scored on the phone, nothing stored

# Behind the scenes · The flow and the stack, *continued*.

## HOW EACH RECORD MOVES, AND WHAT IS IN IT

### Assign and learn

- **Job profile to assignment.** An Oracle HCM role change assigns the learning path. The Foundation course launches from Oracle Learning as a SCORM package.
- **Completions write back.** SCORM reports the course complete to Oracle Learning, against the job profile.

### Assess, practice, measure

- **One record, one flow.** The course posts a JSON record to a Power Automate flow: a SharePoint list row and the branded email, in one run.
- **Survey and completion.** Each cohort survey and each completion posts to the same kind of flow and lands in SharePoint. Lab scores stay on the phone.
- **Scheduled invitation.** A second flow reads the list, invites at 90 days, and stores the retake beside the first score.

# Behind the scenes · The flow and the stack, *continued*.

## HOW EACH RECORD MOVES, AND WHAT IS IN IT

| RECORD | SENT WHEN | HOLDS | LANDS IN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Assessment, initial** | The ten statements are finished before the course | Name, email, date, ten answers, total, the four expectation averages, the suggested first move | SharePoint list, email to the manager |
| **Course complete** | Every activity in the Foundation course is done | Quiz score, the action chosen for the week, the week built | The same list row, email to the manager, SCORM status to Oracle Learning |
| **Cohort survey** | After each of the four sessions | Week, ten answers, team area and type, optional name | SharePoint list |
| **Cohort completion** | The four indicators are ticked and the record sent | Segments done, labs held, both pulse readings, the four indicators, the Playbook lines | SharePoint list |
| **Assessment, retake** | The 90-day invitation is answered | The same as initial, plus the prior score and averages | The same list row |

Team profiles, Playbook drafts, timeline moments and lab outcomes stay in the manager’s own browser unless they choose to send them. Nothing in the cohort is read by a leader without the manager pressing send.

MANAGER DEVELOPMENT JAM SESSION · WHAT WE HEARD

# You stated. We *listened*.

Five themes from the Manager Development Jam Session. Each one shaped the program.

YOU STATED

Make it practical.

WE LISTENED

Real conversations, a three-tap week, the templates.

YOU STATED

Learn across Vanderbilt.

WE LISTENED

Cross-unit cohorts, labs on someone else's case.

# You stated. We listened., *continued*.

**YOU STATED**

Learn by doing.

**WE LISTENED**

Rehearse in a lab, then do it for real.

**YOU STATED**

Build the talent bench.

**WE LISTENED**

Coaching, delegation, a 90-day plan by name.

# You stated. We listened., *continued*.

**YOU STATED**

Reinforce how we lead.

**WE LISTENED**

One standard, taught, practiced, measured.

## WHAT EACH THEME CHANGED, IN FULL

### Make it practical.

*"Give managers simple tools for 1:1s, people decisions, difficult situations, and the everyday work of managing."*

Every activity in the Foundation course is a conversation a manager will actually have, and the course ends with a three-tap week the manager adds to their calendar: 1:1s, the team meeting, the monthly and quarterly work, and what to do as needed.

The Manager Portal holds the 1:1 agenda, the three-line conversation frame, the delegation ladder, and every policy route with the office it goes to, from Day 1 onward.

### Learn across Vanderbilt.

*"Use cross-functional cohorts to build relationships, empathy, and a better understanding of how the university works."*

The four-week cohort seats one hundred managers a quarter from across the 39 business units, in small SparkWise Learning Labs that work a live case from someone else's team, with a classroom week one and a capstone where managers present to peers from other units.

The Vanderbilt & Nashville track covers the mission, the areas of focus, our campuses, and how we work together, and Who to call names the people a manager's team depends on.

# You stated. We listened., *continued*.

## WHAT EACH THEME CHANGED, IN FULL

### Learn by doing.

*"Blend in-person experiences, real scenarios, SMEs, and practice in the flow of work."*

The course teaches through live conversations with a team member who answers back, scored on what the manager says. The cohort rehearses each week's conversation in a simulation lab tailored to the manager's own team, then has it for real: one 1:1 cadence set, one hard conversation held, one decision handed over, with the manager's own team.

Subject-matter experts from seven divisions wrote the routing rules and the Day 30 and Day 60 expectations, and fifteen managers from eight units tested the whole program first.

### Build the talent bench.

*"Help managers spot potential, create enrichment opportunities, enable lateral and diagonal mobility, and develop their successors."*

Growing people and handing over decisions, not just tasks, are written into the standard itself. Week 3 of the cohort is coaching and mentoring: for each person on the team, where they want to be, one stretch assignment, and their rung on the delegation ladder.

The Team Development Plan sets 90-day growth moves by name, is challenged by peers in week 4, and is presented to the business unit leader at the capstone.

# You stated. We listened., *continued*.

## WHAT EACH THEME CHANGED, IN FULL

### Reinforce how we lead.

*"Build shared expectations around collaboration, accountability, sound people practices, and care for frontline staff."*

The Vanderbilt Manager Standard: four expectations of every manager, adapted from Yukl's research, the same in every business unit, taught in the course, measured by the ten-statement assessment before the program and again at 90 days, and practiced in the cohort.

Compliance and the People track put sound people practice on every manager's path, and taking care of the people on the team is one of the four categories, not an elective.

# You stated. We listened., *continued*.

## THE COMMITMENTS WE MADE IN THE ROOM, AND WHERE THEY LED

### Next steps named at the jam session

- Validate internal versus external hiring manager data.
- Invite DAR and Facilities as volunteer pilot partners.
- Present the manager development prototype to VBOM for feedback and further refinement.
- Schedule the next session to review and refine the prototype.

### How the program keeps listening

- The pulse survey before week one and again at the capstone, and the week-four recap, where managers say what happened when they tried it.
- The ten-statement assessment before the program and at 90 days, which shows where the program is working and where it is not.
- Feedback from each cohort shapes the next quarter's design, the same way the pilot shaped this one.

### From the jam session to launch

STEP 1

**Jam session**

Managers and leaders set the five themes and the next steps.

STEP 2

**Expert group**

Seven divisions defined the routing rules, Who to call, and the Day 30 and Day 60 expectations.

STEP 3 · MARCH 26, 2026

**Pilot**

Fifteen managers from eight units completed the full program. Their feedback shaped the current design.

STEP 4 · NOVEMBER 1, 2026

**Wide launch**

Open to all managers, with the first full cohort of one hundred.

WHERE TO START

# Start with the *course*.

Open to every manager today.

Manager Voyage · Futures Learning Hub · People, Culture and Belonging · Vanderbilt University